

6. Education

We must reduce the number of subjects on the standard first round university entrance examination and delay the enforcement time period, plus expand the latitude of choice in the subjects to be tested. The number of academic subjects to be tested in the second round test should be limited to just one, with the main criteria for the evaluation based on an essay and interview covering the one subject area.

There is no alternative except to wait for good sense to come to universities regarding back door entrance to schools. But for schools that have been found to be admitting students through the back door, we will take severe measures such as substantially reducing their subsidies.

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1. Tax Increase

1) We will carry out bold administrative reforms that will simplify administrative structures, abolish the subsidy system, and transfer the regional transfer funds to reduce expenditures. 2) We will reduce the burden on finances by rational reform of the Japanese National Railway, food control system, and health insurance system. 3) We will raise tax revenues by correcting the favorable tax treatment given to doctors and other unfair aspects of the tax system.

If the above measure are carried out, there will be no need

to raise taxes. We oppose the introduction of a general consumption tax for it will hurt family finances. Public finances from now on should place priority on social capital and the expansion of welfare. If local governments are given the right to levy taxes, the issue of finances should be settled.

2. Inflation and Energy

We must take precautions against price gouging as a result of increases in the price of oil; but inflation is not unavoidable. We can prevent inflation by raising the official bank rate and taking the initiative in controlling prices. It is necessary and possible for the Japanese economy to change from export-led growth to domestic-centered growth and still continue medium level economic growth.

We must review our oil dependent energy policy and pour all our efforts into developing clean energy by the 21st century. We will place a moratorium on dangerous nuclear energy and choose a path towards the so-called "soft energy." We will secure 20 million kilowatts of electric power from solar and tidal power, 20 million from wind power, and 50 million from small and medium sized hydro power plants. We can produce liquefied fuel by using organic waste. The only path left for the next generation is towards energy that is in harmony with the environment.

3. Correction of Political Corruption

In order to block corruption, it is necessary to dismantle the alliance system made up of the political and business worlds

and reform it so that politics will not require money. We must revise the laws regulating political funds by making it an obligation for politicians to make public their assets and the sources and expenditures of their political funds, as well as severely restricting the limits of big business contributions.

We will establish a Diet watch dog committee like that of the U.S. Securities Exchange Council and give it strong authority. We will organize an ethics committee. We will revise the criminal legal codes and significantly lengthen the statute of limitations regarding cases of political corruption and expand the scope of the "authority of duty." We will expand the public management of elections and secure the political participation of the people who are not represented by interest groups.

4. Welfare and Expenditures

Instead of high level of welfare with heavy burdens, we will realize high welfare with fair burdens.

Even if patients with minor illnesses pay part of the expenses out of their own pockets, we will promote free care for patients with serious illnesses. We will establish a system of old age medical insurance as part of a comprehensive welfare policy. The welfare system does not maintain fairness for it ignores income differentials. Therefore, we will deal with the aging society by establishing a fair welfare system that places the burden on people according to their income.

5. Diplomacy and Defense

The recently tendency to regard the Soviet Union as a potential enemy is dangerous and impractical. We will strive to conclude quickly a peace treaty with the Soviet Union based on the return of the four islands of the Northern Territories. We will work towards concluding a friendship treaty with the U.S. and demilitarize the security treaty. And we want to build a relationship of neutrality with the U.S., China, the Soviet Union, and the various countries of Asia.

We want to freeze for now defense policy in the present condition, and, based on changes in the international environment and national consensus, we will gradually reduce the Self-Defense Forces. The scale will be confined to coast guard type garrisons.

6. Education

The university system that determines one's job and life depending on the university one enters must be drastically reformed. Medical universities are a typical example. We will revise the National Examination for Medical Practitioners and change it to a judicial examination-type system that allows one from any department to take the examination. Reform should include allowing freedom in changing jobs, guaranteeing the chances for university graduates and workers to have further education.